



October 7th 2019 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RoOE4O8IGak
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, conducting routine county business including contracts, grants, personnel updates, resolutions, and citizen comment periods.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Commissioners explicitly referenced by name or title during roll/voice interactions include Commissioner Henry, Commissioner James, and Sheree (presiding/clerk functions).
 - *Absent:* None explicitly noted in the transcript.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Led by the Board of Commissioners.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not detailed in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made and seconded to approve previous meeting minutes.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:23 Grant Extension Agreement: Juvenile Court Program Coordinator**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff / Emily.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed a grant extension for the juvenile court reporter who also serves as the program coordinator for family recovery (half of her salary is funded by the grant). Because the paperwork had to be signed within a strict 10-day window prior to the meeting, this action served as formal post-hoc board authorization.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:02:25 Retiree Benefits Coverage Extension**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County administration / Sheree.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding an administrative formality to extend existing coverage for remaining retirees. Officials noted the covered group is shrinking with fewer retirees remaining, no new individuals are being added, and the action functions in name only requiring a signature.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:03:26 Emergency Management Performance Grant (EMPG)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers, Public Emergency Management Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Rogers presented the EMPG salary reimbursement grant and requested permission to continue utilizing consulting services.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made, seconded, and Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:04:05 Auditor's Office Consultant Agreements**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed two separate consulting agreements for the auditor's office: one to assist with navigating the complex tax sale process, and a second to assist with transitioning county reporting procedures from a cash basis to GAAP (Generally Accepted Accounting Principles) compliance, which is required to issue new bonds in the future.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:05:28 2020 Holiday Schedule**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the proposed 2020 holiday schedule, noting it remains largely unchanged from previous years.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:06:05 Resolution 2019-0230: New Grant Award & Rule Suspension**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department staff.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff reported on a new grant awarded in mid-September (securing close to \$100,000, which was less than originally requested). The funds will provide salary reimbursements allowing part-time staff to transition to full-time. A motion was made to suspend normal rules to allow immediate consideration.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Rules suspended by voice vote; Resolution 2019-0230 subsequently adopted by voice vote.
- **00:07:45 Resolution on Unsold Tax Sale Properties & Package Bids**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff / Legal counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff updated the commissioners regarding properties from the fall 2018 tax sale where the county acquired deeds. After initial offerings and subsequent package bid deals approved in July, this resolution finalizes the acceptance of highest bids on remaining properties. Approximately 8 small, unmarketable parcels (such as 20x20 foot blocks in the middle of fields) were completely removed from the sale so the county can retain them and attempt to transfer them to adjacent property owners to clean up problematic parcel IDs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:10:50 Planning Commission & Building Department Personnel Introduction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** New Executive Director of the Planning Commission.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The executive director introduced Tom Pouch as the new Building Commissioner (noting his 40 years of construction experience starting right out of high school). The director also publicly thanked outgoing building commissioner Steve Minich for his service and retirement, noting Minich stayed on to help train Pouch. Commissioners briefly discussed ongoing enforcement challenges regarding property maintenance, weeds, and junk cars with the sheriff's department.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational introduction; no formal vote required.
- **00:14:19 Authorization for Deed Signing: County Bridges Community Service Property**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff requested authorization for Sheree to sign a new property deed relating to County Bridges Community Service. Although the property was previously deeded, the transfer was never properly recorded, causing a discrepancy between Beacon and the Recorder's office records. Signing a new deed allows proper recording in both the Auditor's and Recorder's offices.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made, seconded, and Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:20:30 Backboard Committee Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner James / Commissioner Henry.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Following a rule change earlier in the year allowing any commissioner to sit on the backboard, Commissioner James requested to fill the seat previously held by Sheree/Commissioner Henry.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:24:49 Stanley Goodell & Marty Hillary (Country Village & Creekwood Subdivision Representatives)**
 - **Residents:** Stanley Goodell (8410 North Tahoe Drive) and Marty Hillary (8205 North Yellowstone).
 - **Concerns Addressed:** Representing 350 families on the board of directors for the Country Village and Creekwood subdivision in northern Delaware County, the speakers addressed the severe deterioration of neighborhood roads, which have not been paved in 50 years. They highlighted that failing concrete has created major safety hazards, causing vehicle damage and pedestrian injuries requiring emergency room visits (citing Mr. Goodell's wife who suffered a dislocated shoulder after tripping on a crack in Yellowstone Drive). They presented a photo handout and invited commissioners to tour the neighborhood.
 - **Board Response:** Commissioners acknowledged the concerns, noting they have been actively directing paving funds and stormwater resources to various neighborhoods over the past six and a half years. County staff (Angie) and commissioners explained ongoing stormwater, tile cleaning, and creek remediation efforts in the area, including coordination to clear beaver dams and manage grass clippings blocking drainage tiles.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - *EMS Dispatch Discussion:* Earlier in the meeting [00:15:20<U+2013>022:04], Commissioner Henry and Jason Rogers brought up major operational concerns regarding the new Delaware County EMS service and dispatch protocols with the City of Muncie. Commissioners alleged that dispatch was bypassing closer county ambulances in favor of Muncie Fire EMS, questioned emergency response efficiency, criticized the city's dispatch and fire chief directives placing North County EMS fourth in line, and formally stated they have no interest in signing a flawed interlocal agreement with the city that puts county residents at risk.
 - *Monthly Reports:* Monthly departmental reports were received and entered into the record **00:22:18**.

- **Adjournment:** A motion to recess/adjourn was introduced at 00:29:12. *(Exact time of formal gavel not explicitly stated in transcript text).*

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